

DIM

1. Passage anchor

> “It was like a light switching on in a **dim room**.”

Passage meaning

dim = not brightly lit; having only a small amount of light

昏暗的；光線微弱的

So:

a dim room

= **一個光線昏暗的房間**

In the passage, this physical image supports a metaphor:

dim room

→ lack of clarity / uncertainty

light switching on

→ sudden understanding

Practice

1. The restaurant was warm and **dim**.

那家餐廳光線溫暖而**昏暗**。

2. I could barely see his face in the **dim light**.

在**微弱的光線**中，我幾乎看不清他的臉。

Core meanings of DIM

2. dim — not brightly lit

= having little light; not bright

昏暗的；光線微弱的

This is the passage sense and the central physical meaning.

Examples

1. The room was **dim** and quiet.

房間裡**昏暗**而安靜。

2. We walked through a **dim corridor**.

我們走過一條**昏暗的走廊**。

Common nouns:

* dim room 昏暗的房間

* dim corridor 昏暗的走廊

* dim light 微弱的光

* dim lamp 光線微弱的燈

3. dim light

= weak or faint light

微弱的光；昏暗的光線

Examples

1. She read by the **dim light** of a small lamp.

她藉著小燈**微弱的光線**閱讀。

2. A **dim light** came from the hallway.

走廊裡傳來一絲**微弱的光**。

4. dimly lit

= having weak or low lighting

燈光昏暗的；光線不足的

Examples

1. They entered a **dimly lit room**.

他們走進一個**燈光昏暗的房間**。

2. The café was small and **dimly lit**.

那家咖啡館很小，而且**燈光昏暗**。

Very common descriptive phrase.

Faint visibility

5. dim — difficult to see clearly

= faint, unclear, or only weakly visible

****模糊的；隱約可見的****

Examples

1. We could see a ****dim shape**** in the distance.

我們可以看到遠處一個****模糊的輪廓****。

2. A ****dim outline**** of the mountains appeared through the fog.

山脈的****朦朧輪廓****從霧中浮現。

This develops naturally from weak lighting.

6. dim figure / outline / shape

= an object or person that can only be seen faintly

****模糊的人影 / 輪廓 / 形狀****

Examples

1. A ****dim figure**** appeared at the end of the street.

街道盡頭出現一個****模糊的人影****。

2. I could just make out the ****dim outline**** of the building.

我只能勉強看出那棟建築的****模糊輪廓****。

Weak brightness or intensity

7. dim — not shining strongly

= faint in brightness

****暗淡的；微弱的****

Examples

1. The stars looked ****dim**** through the clouds.

星星透過雲層看起來很****暗淡****。

2. The screen became ****dim**** when the battery was low.

電量不足時，螢幕會變得****較暗****。

8. dim screen / display

= a screen with low brightness

****亮度較低的螢幕****

Examples

1. The phone automatically becomes ****dim**** at night.

手機在夜間會自動變得****較暗****。

2. The display was too ****dim**** to read outdoors.

螢幕太****暗****，在戶外看不清楚。

Verb: reduce brightness

9. dim something

= make a light less bright

****調暗；使變暗****

Examples

1. Could you ****dim the lights****?

你可以把燈光****調暗****一點嗎？

2. She ****dimmed the lamp**** before going to bed.

她睡前把燈****調暗了****。

Very common.

10. lights dim

= become less bright

****燈光變暗****

Examples

1. The lights ****dimmed**** before the film began.

電影開始前，燈光****暗了下來****。

2. The room grew quiet as the lights ****dimmed****.

隨著燈光****變暗****，房間也安靜了下來。

This is the intransitive use.

Memory and clarity

11. dim memory / recollection

= a memory that is weak, unclear, or difficult to recall

****模糊的記憶；依稀的印象****

Examples

1. I have only a ****dim memory**** of that day.

我對那一天只有****模糊的記憶****。

2. She had a ****dim recollection**** of meeting him years ago.

她依稀記得多年前曾見過他。

This is a major figurative extension:

weak light

→ weak visibility

→ weak mental clarity

12. a dim awareness

= weak or incomplete awareness of something

****隱約的察覺；模糊的意識****

Examples

1. He had a ****dim awareness**** that something was wrong.

他隱約****察覺到****事情有些不對。

2. I had only a ****dim sense**** of what was happening.

我對正在發生的事情只有****模糊的感覺****。

Hope and prospects

13. dim prospects

= poor or unlikely chances of success

****黯淡的前景；不樂觀的前途****

Examples

1. The company's prospects looked ****dim****.

公司的前景看起來很****黯淡****。

2. Without further funding, their chances are ****dim****.

如果沒有更多資金，他們的機會就很****渺茫****。

This is figurative:

low light → little hope.

14. a dim chance / hope

= a very small or weak possibility

****渺茫的機會；微弱的希望****

Examples

1. There is still a ****dim hope**** that the situation will improve.

仍然有一絲****微弱的希望****，情況會改善。

2. He had only a ****dim chance**** of success.

他成功的機會相當****渺茫****。

Less common than:

* slim chance

* faint hope

but established.

Intelligence / understanding

15. dim — not very intelligent or quick to understand

= slow to understand; not intellectually sharp

****遲鈍的；不太聰明的****

Examples

1. He is not ****dim****; he just needs more time to process the information.
他並不****遲鈍****，只是需要更多時間處理資訊。
2. The character is portrayed as rather ****dim****.
那個角色被描寫得有些****愚鈍****。

This is informal and can sound insulting.

Important

Do not confuse this with:

* dim light = 昏暗

* dim memory = 模糊

* dim person = 遲鈍、不聰明

16. dim-witted

= slow or unintelligent

****愚鈍的；遲鈍的****

Examples

1. The story presents him as a ****dim-witted**** but kind character.
故事把他描寫成一個****有些愚鈍但心地善良****的人。
2. Calling someone ****dim-witted**** is insulting.
稱某人 ****dim-witted**** 帶有侮辱意味。

Useful family extension, but informal and negative.

Eyesight

17. dim eyesight / vision

= weak or failing vision

****視力模糊；視力衰退****

Examples

1. His eyesight had grown ****dim**** with age.

隨著年齡增長，他的視力變得****模糊****。

2. Her vision was ****dim**** in the low light.

在微弱光線下，她的視野顯得****不清楚****。

This use is less common in everyday speech than ****poor eyesight**** or ****blurred vision****, but it is established.

Verb: weaken or fade

18. dim someone's memory

= make a memory less clear

****使記憶變模糊****

Examples

1. Time had ****dimmed his memory**** of the event.

時間使他對那件事的記憶****逐漸模糊****。

2. The years had not completely ****dimmed her memories****.

多年過去仍未完全****沖淡她的記憶****。

19. dim someone's hopes

= weaken confidence or hope

****使希望減弱；使希望變得渺茫****

Examples

1. The latest news ****dimmed their hopes**** of success.

最新消息使他們成功的希望****變得黯淡****。

2. The delay ****dimmed hopes**** of an early solution.

延誤使人們對早日解決問題的希望****降低了****。

20. dim someone's enthusiasm / joy

= reduce the strength of a feeling

****削弱；沖淡****

Examples

1. The criticism did not ****dim her enthusiasm****.

那些批評並沒有****削弱她的熱情****。

2. Nothing could ****dim their joy****.

任何事情都無法****沖淡他們的喜悅****。

This is figurative and somewhat literary.

Figurative fading

21. something dims

= gradually become weaker, less vivid, or less intense

****逐漸淡去；逐漸減弱****

Examples

1. The memory slowly ****dimmed**** with time.

那段記憶隨時間逐漸****淡去****。

2. Her excitement began to ****dim****.

她的興奮感開始****逐漸減弱****。

Fixed and high-value expressions

22. take a dim view of something

= strongly disapprove of something

****對.....很不以為然；非常不贊成****

Examples

1. The manager ****takes a dim view of**** lateness.

經理對遲到這件事**非常不以為然**。

2. My parents **took a dim view of** my decision.
我父母對我的決定**很不贊成**。

This is highly idiomatic.

It does NOT literally mean “看得不清楚.”

23. in the dim and distant past

= a very long time ago

在遙遠的過去；很久以前

Examples

1. I learned that **in the dim and distant past**.
那是我**很久以前**學的。
2. The building was once a school **in the dim and distant past**.
那棟建築在**很久以前**曾是一所學校。

Often humorous or informal.

Related forms

24. dimly

= with little light, clarity, or certainty

昏暗地；模糊地；隱約地

A. light

The room was **dimly lit**.
房間裡**燈光昏暗**。

B. memory / awareness

I **dimly remembered** his face.
我**依稀記得**他的臉。

Examples

1. I **dimly recall** seeing her before.

我**依稀記得**以前見過她。

2. The hallway was **dimly illuminated**.

走廊裡只有**微弱的照明**。

25. dimness

= lack of brightness, clarity, or vividness

昏暗；模糊；暗淡

Examples

1. My eyes slowly adjusted to the **dimness**.

我的眼睛慢慢適應了周圍的**昏暗**。

2. The **dimness** of the memory made details difficult to recall.

記憶的**模糊**使細節難以回想。

26. dimmer

A. dimmer switch

= a control that adjusts the brightness of a light

調光器；調光開關

Examples

1. Use the **dimmer** to lower the lights.

使用**調光器**把燈調暗。

2. The room has a **dimmer switch**.

房間裡裝有**調光開關**。

B. comparative adjective

dimmer = less bright / less clear

更暗的；更模糊的

Key contrasts

27. dim vs dark

****dark****

= having very little or no light

****黑暗的****

****dim****

= having some light, but not much

****昏暗的****

Compare:

> The room was ****dim****.

> 房間光線很弱，但還有一些光。

> The room was ****dark****.

> 房間很黑，可能幾乎沒有光。

This is an important distinction.

28. dim vs faint

Both can mean weak, but their typical use differs.

dim

commonly describes:

* light

* visibility

* memory

* prospects

faint

commonly describes:

* sound

* smell

* light

* traces

* possibility

Compare:

* a **dim** light*

* a **faint** sound*

Both can describe light, but **dim** is especially natural for low brightness.

29. dim vs dull

dim

= low in brightness or clarity

昏暗的；模糊的

dull

can mean:

* not bright or shiny

* boring

* blunt

* not sharp mentally

Compare:

> a **dim** room*

> 昏暗的房間

> a **dull** colour*

> 暗淡、不鮮明的顏色

The words overlap in some contexts but have different semantic ranges.

30. dim vs blurry

dim

= hard to see mainly because there is not enough light or because something is faint

昏暗的；隱約的

blurry

= lacking visual sharpness or focus

模糊不清的

Compare:

> The figure was **dim** in the darkness.
> 那個人影在黑暗中**隱約可見**。

> The photograph was **blurry**.
> 那張照片**失焦模糊**。

31. dim vs vague

dim

can describe weak memory or awareness.

vague

means lacking clear detail or precision.

Compare:

> I have a **dim memory** of the event.
> 我對那件事只有**依稀的記憶**。

> I have a **vague idea** of what happened.
> 我對發生的事情只有一個**模糊的大概概念**。

32. dim vs gloomy

dim

describes low light.

gloomy

often combines darkness with a sad, depressing, or pessimistic feeling.

Compare:

> a **dim room**
> 光線昏暗的房間

> a **gloomy room**
> 陰暗、讓人感到壓抑的房間

Meaning map

The central concept of **dim** is:

low brightness

From that develop several metaphorical branches:

Physical light

dim room / dim light

→ **昏暗的；微弱的**

Visibility

dim figure / dim outline

→ **模糊的；隱約可見的**

Mental clarity

dim memory / dim awareness

→ **模糊的；依稀的**

Hope and prospects

dim prospects

→ **黯淡的；渺茫的**

Mental ability

a dim person

→ **遲鈍的**

Verb

dim the lights

→ **調暗**

memory dims

→ **逐漸淡去**

hopes are dimmed

→ **希望被削弱**

The semantic bridge is consistent:

****less light → less visibility → less clarity → less hope/intensity****

Passage recap

> “It was like a light switching on in a ****dim room****.”

Here:

****dim** = **not brightly lit; having weak light****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****昏暗的****

* ****光線微弱的****

* ****幽暗的**** depending on style

Natural passage translation:

****那就像在一個昏暗的房間裡突然亮起了一盞燈。 ****

The metaphor contrasts:

****dimness****

→ confusion / lack of clarity

with

****light switching on****

→ sudden understanding / realization

MCQ-ready meaning

****dim** in ****“a dim room”******

= **not brightly lit**

****昏暗的 ; 光線微弱的****

It does not mean “unintelligent” or “unlikely” here, although those figurative senses develop from the same core idea of ****reduced brightness or clarity****.